

Dithering uses the colours in the colour table to build the closest possible colour to the original one. Greater values for dithering will lead to greater file sizes, so keep this as low as possible.

Converting to GIF is nearly always going to wreak havoc with any transparent or semi-transparent areas that you have in your image; turn on Transparency to build a separate colour table for transparent colours. If you turn it off, transparent areas will be filled with the Matte colour or White if you haven't selected one.

Finally, you can choose whether or not the GIF will be interlaced. Being "interlaced" means it will download in passes rather than all in one shot. You could also decide to use a Unified Colour Table, which applies the same colour table to all frames of the animation and all rollover states (we'll be coming to these soon). The Add Metadata option lets you add data about the image in the header of the image.

You can mix and match optimisation settings within the same image as well using *slices*, discussed later in this chapter.